

Field Guide to Alpine Weather

Mountain weather is a system of fast promises and slow apologies. This guide explains the signals that matter and the ones that merely decorate the sky.

Reading the Morning Sky

A hard blue dawn after a windless night usually buys you six safe hours. Lenticular caps over the ridge, by contrast, are the range clearing its throat.

Cloud Sequences

Cirrus thickening into a milky sheet, then lowering, is the classic warm front arriving on schedule. Count the hours, not the clouds.

Afternoon Convection

Cumulus that towers before noon will not politely wait for your descent. Turn around while the anvil is still a rumour.